CHARACTER BOOKLET · No. 20

Charlie *Okonjo*

CHEESE SHOP OWNER

"You know 200 cheeses by smell and every guest by their favorite one."



FOR YOUR EYES ONLY

OPTIONAL CHARACTER
JOINS AT 11+ PLAYERS

WHAT TO WEAR

Dress style: a wrap dress, a cheese-wedge brooch and a little chalkboard name tag.

Suit style: a waistcoat, rolled sleeves, a cheese-wedge pin and the same chalkboard tag.

YOUR DISH TO BRING

Autumn cheese board

Store-bought is fine. Bring it in a dish you love and set it by your table tent.

How this booklet works

Before guests arrive: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.

Appetizers · Round 1: when the host starts Round 1, open page 3.

The Main Course · Round 2: the lower half of page 3.

Pie · Round 3: page 4. Then everyone votes over coffee.

Accusation over coffee: fill in your ballot. Then the truth is read aloud.

Printing? Single-sided, please, or cut page 3 on its dashed line, so later rounds can't show through.

THE GATHERING

The tenth annual Friendsgiving at Juniper Barn. Before the meal, cooking-show star Marigold "Goldie" Ashby tasted the first spoonful of gravy from her antique silver gravy boat, said she felt tired, settled into the rocking chair and never woke up. Every guest brought a dish. Every guest had a reason.

Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

Your Secret Page

You are innocent.

You did not harm Goldie. You may still have something to hide.

If you are not in the game, nothing breaks: the case is fully solvable without this booklet.

Your story and your secret

For two seasons you supplied cheese for Goldie's show, and Goldie still owes you for most of it. Now the new show will use a supermarket sponsor. You were alone in the old milk room before dinner. You never hurt anyone.

Where you were (your alibi)

- 5:15–5:55: alone in the old milk room at the back of the barn (its own outside door), arranging the cheese board.
- 5:18: Goldie brought you a spoonful from the gravy pot to taste. It was delicious, not a hint of bitterness.
- 6:00: carried the board into the hall as everyone gathered for the first taste.

Your goal

Clear your name and help solve the case. Keep the unpaid bill quiet until Round 3.

If someone asks you…

"Where were you at ten to six?" → "In the milk room, building the cheese board."

"Did Goldie owe you money?" → "Ask me in Round 3."

"Was the gravy all right?" → "The pot was perfect. I tasted it at 5:18 and I'm fine."

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

PLAYING TIP

Stay in character and read your Share lines aloud when a round opens. Write down every time you hear on your Detective Notes: someone's story will not match the clock. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet says to share it, but never lie about the evidence.

Appetizers • *Round 1*

ROUND 1 · WAIT FOR THE HOST

Read only when the host starts Round 1.

Share

- You built tonight's autumn cheese board in the old milk room at the back of the barn.
- Goldie's favorite cheese is aged cheddar, and she always says so on TV.

KEEP QUIET FOR NOW · The unpaid cheese bill.

Ask

- **Casey:** "Is the show changing sponsors?"
- **Sage:** "Which cheese goes best with your pie?"

Your mission

Guess three guests' favorite cheeses before they tell you, and keep score.

NOTES

✂ CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE HOST

The Main Course • *Round 2*

ROUND 2 · WAIT FOR THE HOST

Read only when the host starts Round 2.

Share

- At 5:18 Goldie brought you a spoonful from the gravy pot to taste. Delicious, not a hint of bitterness, and you are perfectly fine. The pot was fine.
- From 5:15 to 5:55 you were alone in the milk room with the cheese board.

Ask

- **Avery:** "Was anything added to the pot after 5:18?"
- **Quinn:** "Who walked through the hall before six?"

Your mission

Tell two players that the pot was fine, and ask them what that means for the boat.

NOTES

Pie • *Round 3*

Read only when the host starts Round 3.

Share

- Your secret: Goldie owed you for two seasons of cheese, and the new show was switching to a supermarket sponsor. Annoying, not deadly.
- You carried the board in at 6:00 with everyone else.

Ask

- **Morgan:** "Does the cookbook pay suppliers like me?"
- **Jules:** "Will the family settle Goldie's bills?"

Your mission

Toast the cooks with a cheese cube, then name your top suspect.

Who's who (public info · optional characters may not be playing)

10 Avery Quill
Barn owner & this year's host · *Roasted pumpkin soup*

11 Sage Montrose
Three-time pie contest champion · *Maple pecan pie*

12 Quinn Delacroix
Owner of Delacroix Cider Mill · *Hot spiced apple cider*

13 Morgan Feld
Cookbook editor · *Cranberry sauce*

14 Casey Thornbury
Producer of Supper with Goldie · *Mushroom stuffing*

15 Jules Carraway
Goldie's cousin · *Cheesy scalloped potatoes*

16 Harper Lindqvist (OPT.)
Farmers' market grower · *Roasted root vegetables*

17 Skyler Bontempo (OPT.)
Food truck owner · *Cornbread*

18 Arden Fairweather (OPT.)
The neighbor next door · *Green bean casserole*

19 Indigo Pike (OPT.)
Turkey farmer · *Roast turkey*

20 Charlie Okonjo (OPT.)
Cheese shop owner · *Autumn cheese board*

21 Wren Abernathy (OPT.)
Goldie's old roommate · *Homemade dinner rolls*

NOTES